KFF

The independent source for health policy research, polling, and news.

September 2024 | Poll Finding

KFF Health Tracking Poll September 2024: Harris v. Trump on Key Health Care Issues

Ashley Kirzinger, Grace Sparks, Isabelle Valdes, Julian Montalvo III, and Liz Hamel

Key Takeaways

- Four in ten voters (38%) choose the economy and inflation as the most important issue determining their vote this fall from a list of national issues, including several health care issues. As the economy looms large in the 2024 election, voters from both parties want their candidates to talk about health care costs. When voters are asked to offer in their own words what health care issue they most want to hear the candidates talk about, about four in ten voters across partisanship mention issues related to the cost of health care. Democratic and Democratic-leaning independent voters say they would like Vice President Harris to talk about general health care costs (20%), prescription drug costs (15%), and the cost of insurance or reducing their monthly premiums (6%). About one in seven offered abortion as the one health care issue they want to hear about from Harris and 13% mentioned universal health care – an issue that was largely debated during the 2020 Democratic primaries. Similarly, nearly half (45%) of Republican voters and Republican-leaning independent voters say they would most like to hear former President Trump talk about health care costs. This is followed by one in eight (12%) who say they want to hear him talk about Medicare, Medicaid, or Social Security.

- Abortion continues to motivate a small group of voters, mainly Democratic and Democratic-leaning independent women voters of reproductive age (ages 18-49). About a fifth of this voting bloc say abortion is their most important voting issue and half say they will *only* vote for a candidate who shares their views on abortion. Overall, this group of voters wants abortion to be legal and the vast majority (90%) say they want a federal law restoring a nationwide right to abortion similar to what was protected by *Roe v. Wade*. The share of Democratic-leaning women of reproductive age who say they think the presidential election will have a major impact on abortion access has increased 31 percentage points in the past six months (90% v. 59%), a time in which Vice President Harris became the Democratic presidential nominee and began highlighting the issue in her campaign.

- A majority of all voters now say they trust the Democratic nominee more to handle the issue of abortion compared to former President Trump (53% v. 34%), widening a much smaller advantage that President Biden had over Trump earlier this year (38% v. 29%), a sign of Harris's relative strength with Democratic voters on this issue.

- Voters largely prefer a federal law restoring a nationwide right to abortion, similar to what was protected by *Roe v. Wade* (61%), rather than leaving it up to the states to decide whether abortion is legal or not (39%). Majorities of both Democratic voters (87%) and independent voters (68%) would prefer a federal law restoring the nationwide right to an abortion, the policy position of the Democratic presidential candidate V.P. Harris, while seven in ten Republican voters would prefer leaving abortion laws up to the states, the position advocated by former President Trump. Notably, while the vast majority of Democratic and Democratic-leaning women voters of reproductive age support restoring a federal law for a nationwide right to abortion, this policy proposal is also preferred by half of Republican women voters of reproductive age.

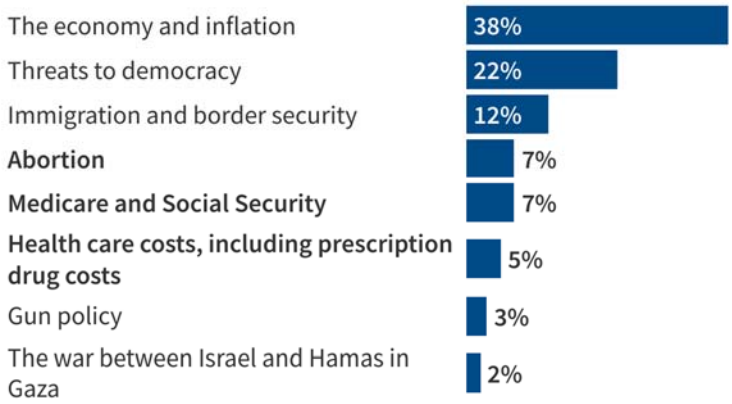
How Voters Are Prioritizing Health Care Issues in 2024

The economy and inflation continue to dominate the list of issues that voters are focusing on during this year's presidential election with four in ten voters (38%) saying it is the most important issue determining their vote in the 2024 presidential race. Following the economy is threats to democracy (22%), immigration and border security (12%), then several individual health care issues including abortion (7%), Medicare and Social Security (7%), and health care costs, including prescription drug costs (5%). Altogether, health care issues are seen as the most important issue by about one in five voters (19%). Gun policy (3%) and the war between Israel and Hamas in Gaza (2%) rank the lowest among the issues included in the list provided to voters.

Figure 1

Individual Health Care Issues Rank Behind Other Key Topics for Voters This Fall

Thinking about the 2024 presidential race, what is the most important issue determining your vote?



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

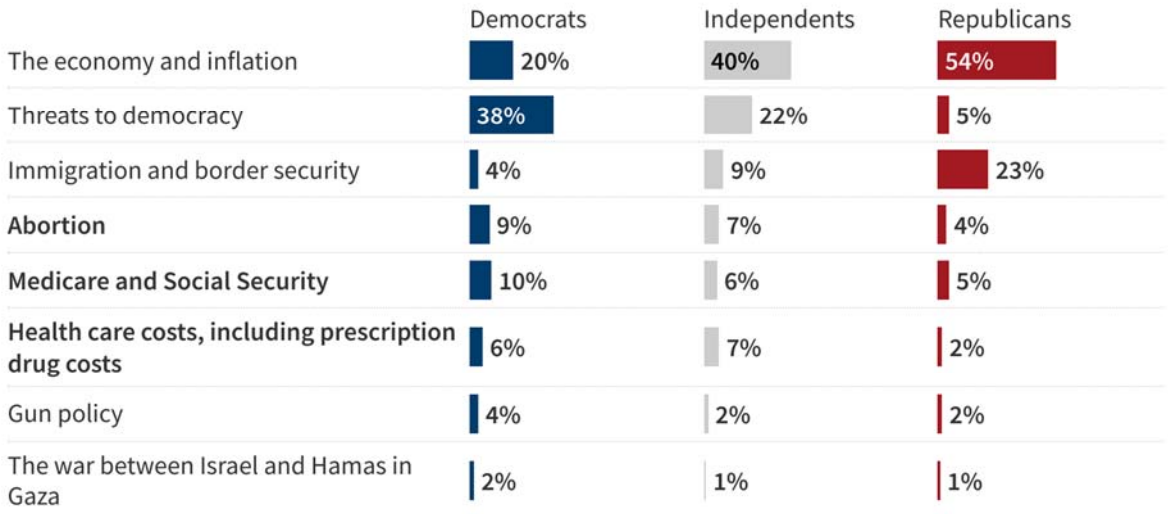
While substantial shares of voters across partisanship say the economy and inflation is their most important voting issue including more than half (54%) of Republican voters, the ranking of other issues are more partisan. For example, Republican voters are much more likely to prioritize immigration as a

voting issue with nearly a quarter (23%) saying it is the most important issue to their vote compared to one in ten independent voters (9%) and few Democratic voters (4%). On the other hand, threats to democracy is the top voting issue for Democratic voters with four in ten (38%) saying it is their most important issue, compared to one in five independent voters (22%) and 5% of Republican voters who say the same.

Figure 2

While Economy Ranks High Across All Voters, Other Issues Are More Partisan

Thinking about the 2024 presidential race, what is the most important issue determining your vote?



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

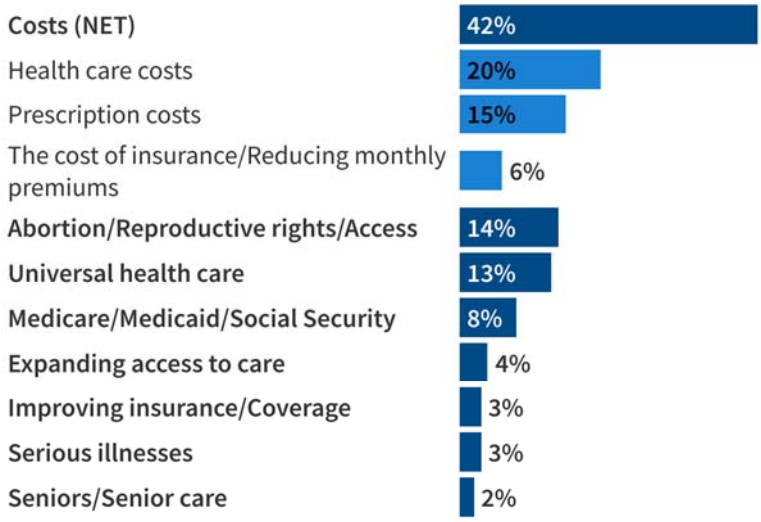
Voters Want to Hear Candidates Talk About Lowering Health Care Costs

An indication of how the economy and health care consistently overlap for voters, economic concerns also rear up when voters are asked what health care issue they most want to hear the candidates talk about. Across partisans, the recurring theme is costs. Responses related to health care costs are offered by four in ten (42%) Democratic and Democratic-leaning independent voters when asked to say in their own words what is the one health care issue they would most like Vice President Harris to talk about. This includes voters who mentioned general health care costs (20%), prescription drug costs (15%), and the cost of insurance or reducing their monthly premiums (6%). About one in seven offered abortion as the one health care issue they want Harris to talk about and 13% mentioned universal health care – an issue that was largely debated during the 2020 Democratic primaries.

Figure 3

Costs Tops List of Health Care Issues Democratic and Democratic-Leaning Voters Want to Hear Harris Talk About

What one health care issue would you most like to hear Kamala Harris talk about? *open-end*



Note: Among registered voters who identify as Democrats or Democratic-leaning independents. Responses above 1% shown. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

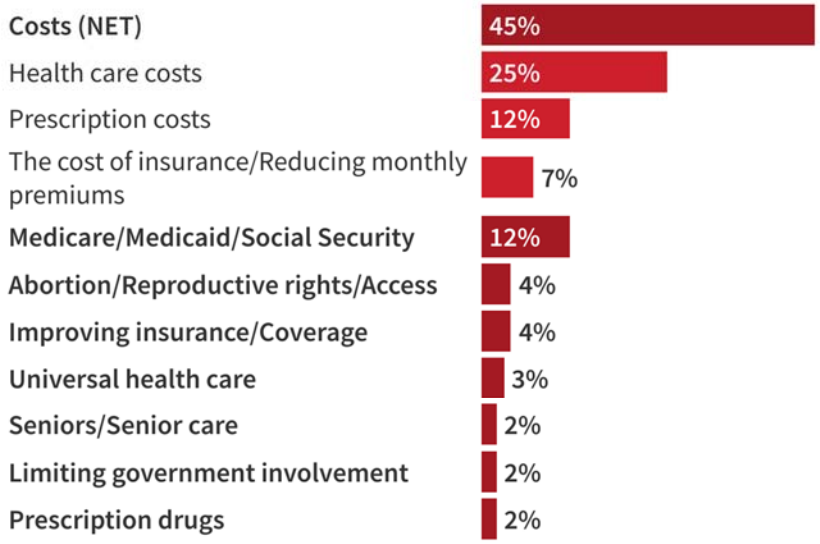
KFF

Similarly, nearly half (45%) of Republican voters and Republican-leaning independent voters say they would most like to hear former President Trump talk about health care costs. This is followed by one in eight voters who say they want to hear him talk about Medicare, Medicaid, or Social Security.

Figure 4

Costs Tops List of Health Care Issues Republican and Republican-Leaning Voters Want to Hear Trump Talk About

What one health care issue would you most like to hear Donald Trump talk about? *open-end*



Note: Among registered voters who identify as Republicans or Republican-leaning independents. Responses above 1% shown. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

Health Care Issues, Including Abortion, Resonate Highest With Certain Voters

Overall, the individual health care issues included in the list loom larger for Democratic voters, as they are more than twice as likely as Republican voters to select abortion, Medicare and Social Security, or health care costs as their most important voting issue (25% v. 11%). One in five independent voters also chose a health care issue as their most important voting issue. In addition, women voters are about twice as likely as men to choose a health care issue as their most important voting issue this fall (25% vs. 12%). Democratic voters and women voters have long been more likely to prioritize health care issues than their counterparts, except for Republican voters' focus on repealing the ACA, but this election cycle is slightly different. In the first presidential election since the Supreme Court *Dobbs* decision that overturned *Roe v. Wade,* abortion is now a top voting issue for about one in ten Democratic voters and a similar share of overall women voters.

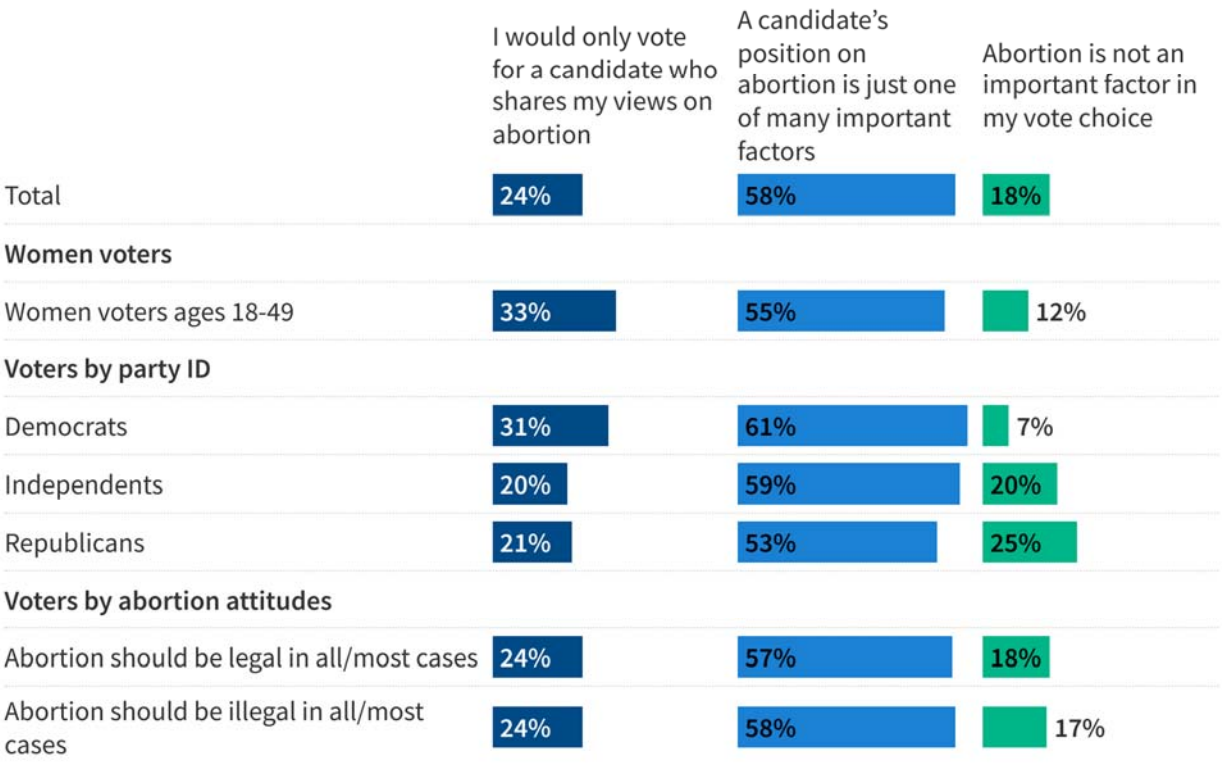
Overall, most voters (58%) say a candidate's position on abortion is just one of many factors that might affect their vote this year while about a quarter of voters say they will only vote for a candidate who shares their views on abortion. About one in five (18%) voters say abortion isn't an important factor in their vote choice.

Democratic voters are more likely to say they will only vote for a candidate who shares their view on abortion (31%), but still most say it is just one of many factors (61%). The same is true among all women of reproductive age, with one in three saying they would only vote for a candidate who shares their view on abortion.

Figure 5

Most Say Candidate's Positions on Abortion Is Just One of Many Factors in Vote Choice

Thinking about how the issue of abortion might affect your vote this year, which comes closer to your view:



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

Abortion Is an Important Voting Issue for Democratic Women of Reproductive Age

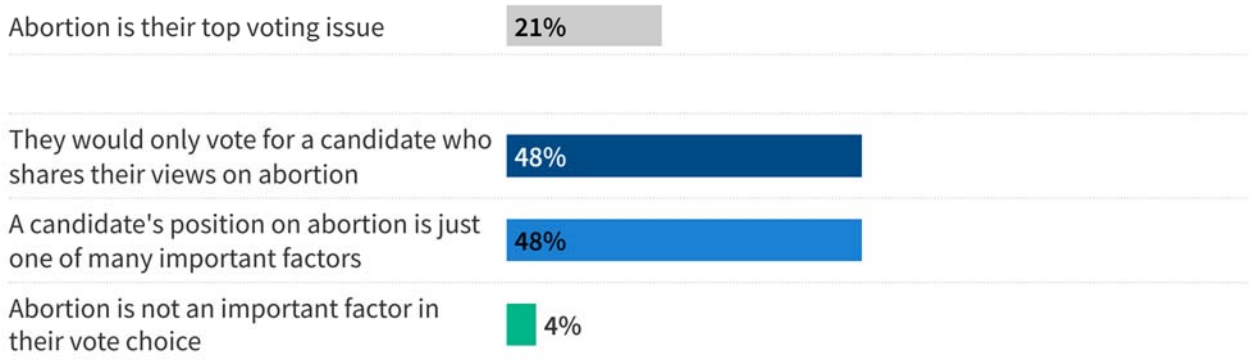
While abortion may not resonate as a top voting issue for all voters, for a key group of voters – Democratic women voters of reproductive age – abortion is among the most important voting issues.

Abortion ranks as a top voting issue for Democratic and Democratic-leaning women of reproductive age (between the ages of 18 and 49), with 21% saying it is their most important issue, ranking alongside the economy (23%) and threats to democracy (25%) as their top voting issue.

Half of Democratic women of reproductive age, the group that is most likely to prioritize abortion as a voting issue, say they will only vote for a candidate who shares their view on abortion (48%), a position they hold more often than any other group. A similar share (48%) say abortion is one of many important factors, while few say abortion is not an important factor in their vote choice (4%). This group is largely in support of abortion access with nine in ten (93%) Democratic women of reproductive age saying they think abortion should be legal in all or most cases.

Figure 6

Democratic Women Voters Are More Likely to Prioritize Abortion as a Voting Issue, Half Say They Will Only Vote for a Candidate Who Shares Their Views on the Issue



Note: Among registered voters. Democrats include those who lean toward the Democratic Party. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

Vice President Harris Has Strong Advantage on Abortion, Former President Trump Leads on Economy and Immigration

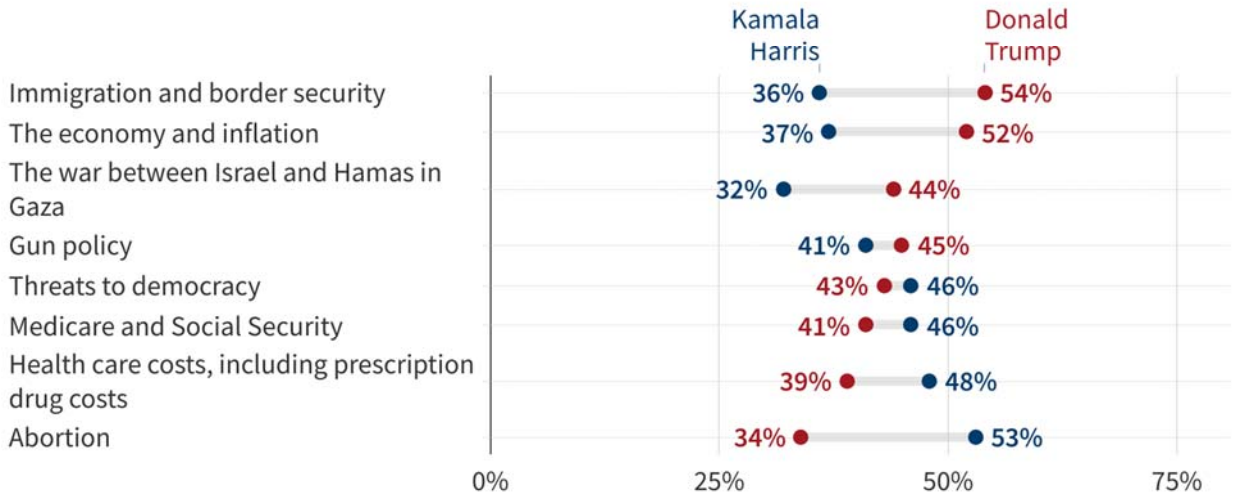
Former President Trump has a clear advantage over Vice President Harris on who voters trust to do a better job dealing with two key issues: economy and inflation (52% vs. 37%) and immigration and border security (54% vs. 36%). On the other hand, Vice President Harris has nearly a similar advantage on the issue of abortion (53% vs. 34%). A KFF Tracking Poll conducted earlier this year when President Biden was still the Democratic nominee found that Biden had a smaller advantage over Trump on abortion (38% v. 29%), a sign of Harris's relative strength with Democratic voters on this issue.

Neither candidate has a majority of voters saying they trust them more to do a better job on any of the other key voting issues asked about including Medicare and Social Security or health care costs. However, V.P. Harris does have the advantage on the issue of health care costs. Former President Trump garners more trust on the issue of the war between Israel and Hamas in Gaza, but a substantial share of voters say they trust neither candidate to do a better job of handling this issue.

Figure 7

Former President Trump Has Advantage on Immigration and Economy, V.P. Harris Holds Advantage on Abortion

Regardless of who you intend to vote for in the upcoming elections, which presidential candidate do you trust to do a better job dealing with each of the following?



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

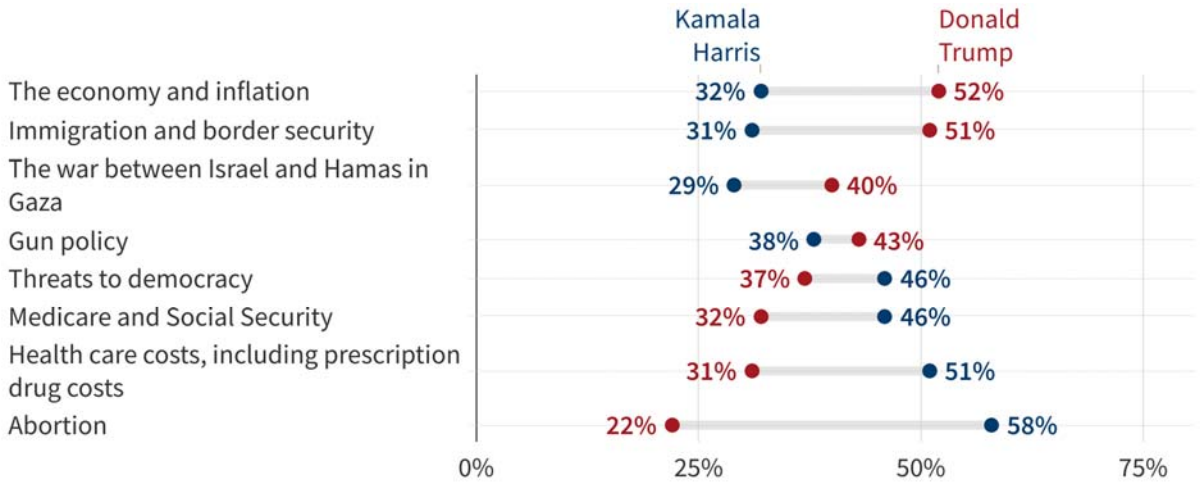
Both presidential candidates are trying to garner support from independent voters and these voters give former President Trump the advantage on their top voting issue – the economy and inflation. About half of independent voters (52%) say they trust former President Trump to do a better job dealing with the economy and inflation, while a third (32%) of independent voters say they trust V.P. Harris to do a better job. V.P. Harris holds a much smaller advantage on their second most important voting issue – threats to democracy (46% vs. 37%). Across the three health care issues, V.P. Harris has a strong advantage over former President Trump among independent voters including a 36-point advantage on the issue of abortion. On the other hand, former President Trump holds a 20-point advantage on the issue of immigration and border security.

Figure 8

Independent Voters Give Former President Trump Clear Advantage on the Economy and Immigration, V.P. Harris Has Even Bigger Advantage on Abortion

Among independents:

Regardless of who you intend to vote for in the upcoming elections, which presidential candidate do you trust to do a better job dealing with each of the following?



Note: Among registered voters who identify as independents. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

Most Voters Expect Presidential Election to Have Major Impact on Abortion Policy

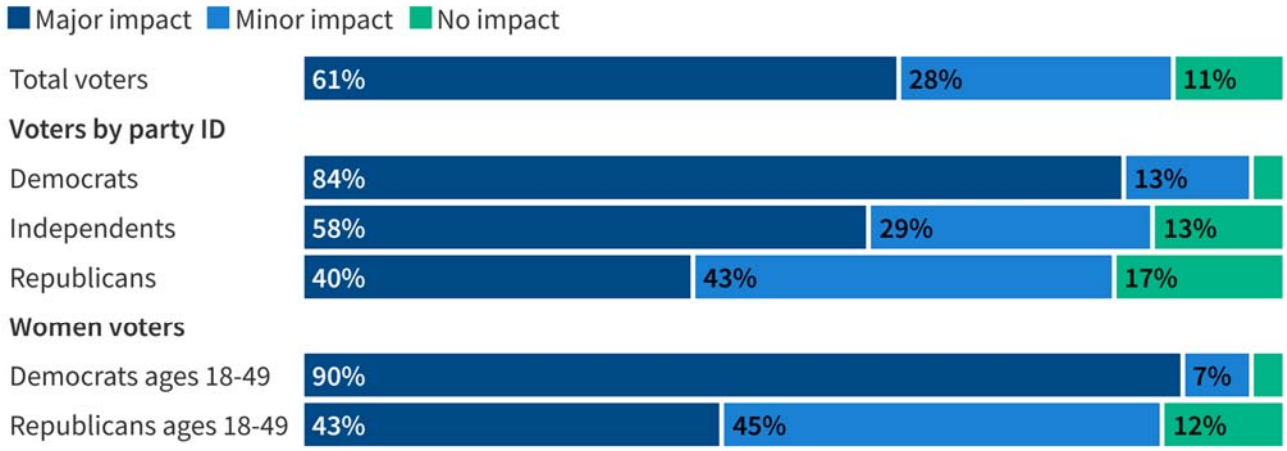
Nine in ten (89%) voters say this year's elections for president will have an impact on abortion access in the U.S., including six in ten (61%) voters who say it will have a "major impact." One in ten (11%) voters think the election will not have any impact on access to abortion in the U.S.

Democratic voters are more than twice as likely as Republican voters (84% vs. 40%) to say the election will have a major impact on abortion access. Three-fourths (72%) of women voters of reproductive age, those most directly impacted by abortion policy in the U.S., say the presidential election will have a major impact on abortion access, rising to nine in ten Democratic and Democratic-leaning independent women voters ages 18-49. On the other hand, four in ten (43%) Republican and Republican-leaning independent women voters of reproductive age say the same.

Figure 9

Majorities of Voters Think This Year's Presidential Election Will Have a Major Impact on Abortion Access in the U.S.

Do you think this year's election for president will have a major impact, a minor impact, or no impact on access to abortion in the U.S.?



Note: Among registered voters. Women voters by party ID includes independents who lean toward either party. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

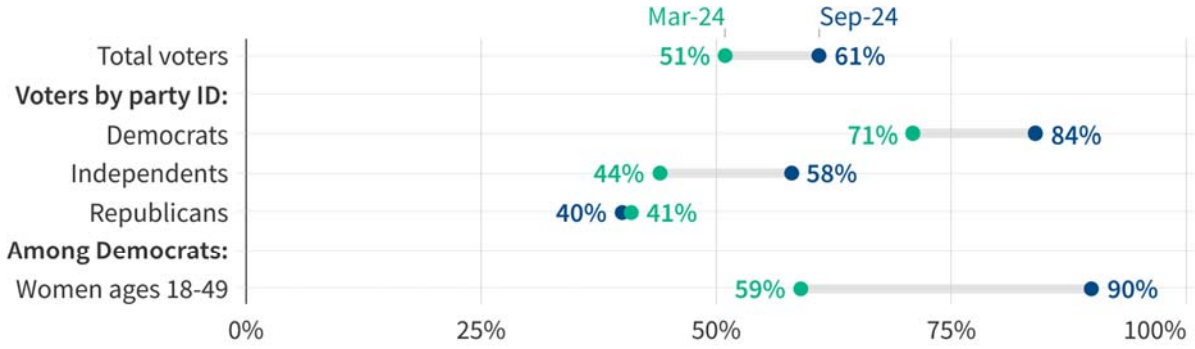
A larger share of voters now say that this election will have a “major” impact on abortion access than the share who said so in March of this year when President Biden was still on the ballot, perhaps reflecting the current president’s uneasiness with the issue. Currently, six in ten (61%) voters think this election will have a “major” impact, compared to about half (51%) in March. Some of the largest changes have been among independent voters and Democratic voters, with 84% of Democratic voters now saying the presidential election will have a major impact on abortion access, up from 71% in March. Similarly, 58% of independent voters say the same, a 14-percentage point increase from 44% in March. The share of Republican voters who say the election will have a major impact has remain unchanged.

Democratic and Democratic-leaning independent women voters of reproductive age (ages 18-49) are also now placing a higher emphasis on this election’s impact on abortion access. In the most recent tracking poll, nine in ten Democratic women under age 50 now say this year’s presidential election will have a major impact on abortion access in the U.S., compared to just 59% who said the same in March of this year.

Figure 10

Larger Shares of Voters Now Say This Year's Presidential Election Will Have a Major Impact on Abortion Access Than in March

Percent of voters who say this year's election for president will have a **major impact** on abortion access in the U.S.:



Note: Among registered voters. Democratic women ages 18-49 includes independents who lean toward the Democratic Party. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

Six In Ten Voters Want *Roe* Protections Restored

Six in ten (61%) voters would prefer a federal law restoring a nationwide right to abortion, similar to what was protected by *Roe v. Wade*, while four in ten (39%) would prefer to leave it up to the states to decide whether abortion is legal or not in each state.

Majorities of both Democratic voters and independent voters would prefer a federal law restoring a nationwide right to abortion, with nearly nine in ten (87%) Democratic voters and two-thirds (68%) of independent voters who say so. Seven in ten Republican voters would prefer leaving abortion laws up to the states.

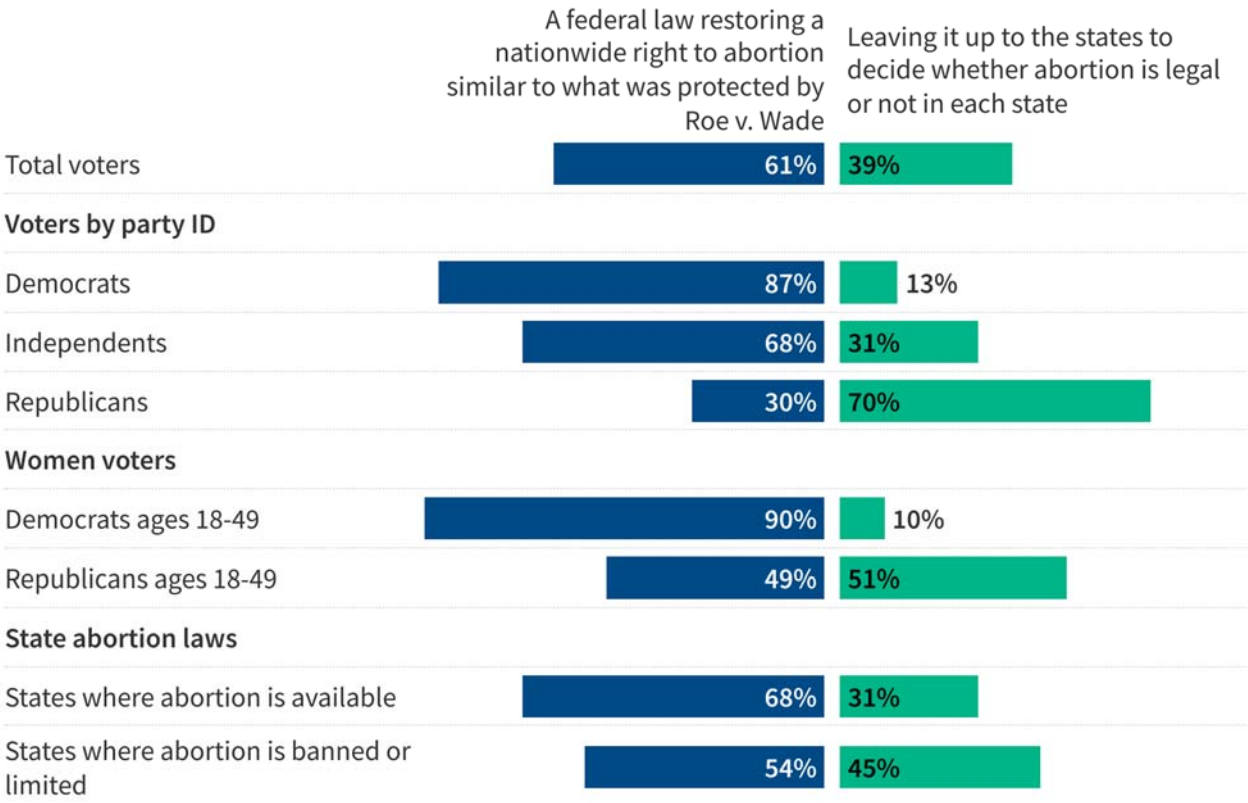
Nine in ten Democratic and Democratic-leaning women voters who are of reproductive age support restoring a federal law for a nationwide right to abortion, while Republican women voters of reproductive age are more divided with similar shares saying they would prefer a federal law restoring a nationwide right to abortion (49%) or leaving it up to the states (51%).

Nearly seven in ten voters who live in states where abortion is legal and available support a federal law restoring a nationwide right to abortion (68%), as do a majority of voters living in states where abortion is banned or limited (54%).

Figure 11

Majorities of Voters Support a Federal Law Restoring Nationwide Right to Abortion

Percent who say they would prefer...



Note: Among registered voters. Women voters by party ID includes independents who lean toward either party. States where abortion is banned as of fielding: AL, AR, ID, IN, KY, LA, MO, MS, ND, OK, SD, TN, TX, WV. States where abortion is limited: AZ, FL, GA, IA, KS, NC, NE, OH, SC, UT, WI. States where abortion is legal: AK, CA, CO, CT, DC, DE, HI, IL, MA, MD, ME, MI, MN, MT, NH, NJ, NM, NV, NY, OR, PA, RI, VA, VT, WA, WY. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

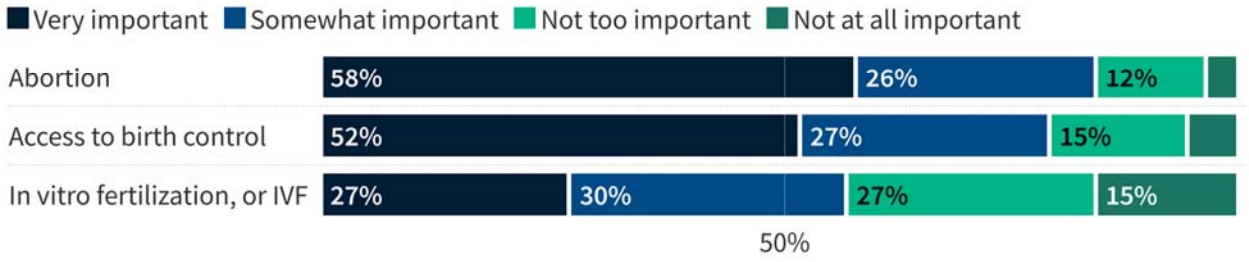
This is especially important as ten states are set to have voters cast ballots on abortion-related measures in the 2024 election. In those states, 62% of voters say they would prefer to have a federal law restoring a nationwide right to abortion similar to what was protected by *Roe*.

As the presidential campaigns continue, a majority of voters say it is important for the 2024 presidential candidates to talk about abortion (84%), access to birth control (79%), and in vitro fertilization, or IVF, (57%) on the campaign trail.

Figure 12

Majority of Voters Say It Is Important for Presidential Candidates to Talk About Reproductive Health Issues

In general, how important, if at all, do you think it is for the 2024 presidential candidates to talk about each of the following?



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

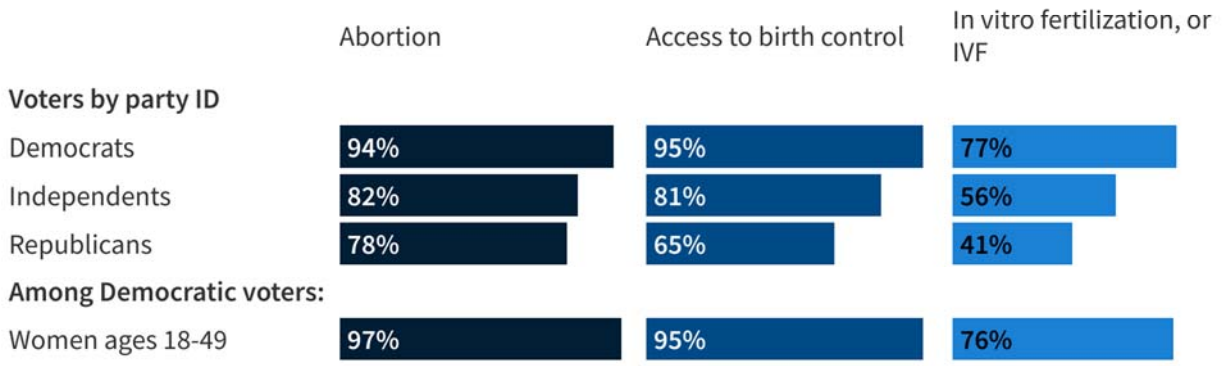
At least three-quarters of Democratic voters say it is either “very important” or “somewhat important” for the candidates to talk about each of these issues, as do a majority of independent voters. A majority of Republican voters agree, albeit to a lesser degree, that it is important for the presidential candidates to discuss abortion and birth control access, but less than half say the same about IVF.

At least nine in ten Democratic and Democratic-leaning women of reproductive age say it is important for the candidates to discuss abortion (97%) and access to birth control (95%) on the campaign trail, and three quarters (76%) say it is important for the candidates to talk about IVF.

Figure 13

Voters, Especially Democratic Voters, Want to Hear Candidates Discuss Reproductive Health Issues

Percent of voters who say it is **very** or **somewhat important** for the 2024 presidential candidates to talk about each of the following:



Note: Among registered voters. Democratic women ages 18-49 includes independents who lean toward the Democratic party. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

KFF

The independent source for health policy research, polling, and news.

September 2024 | Poll Finding

KFF Health Tracking Poll September 2024: Support for Reducing Prescription Drug Prices Remains High, Even As Awareness of IRA Provisions Lags

Grace Sparks, Ashley Kirzinger, Isabelle Valdes, Julian Montalvo III, and Liz Hamel

Key Takeaways

- The Biden administration recently announced a projected reduction of out-of-pocket costs for seniors as part of the Medicare drug negotiations, yet large majorities of voters have not heard about these savings, with almost half (45%) who say they have heard "nothing at all," while a quarter have heard "a lot" or "some." Larger shares of older voters, those ages 65 and older, say they've heard "a lot" or "some" about these savings, with a third (32%) who say so, compared to two in ten (22%) of those under age 65. Most voters continue to be unaware of the Medicare drug pricing provisions in the Inflation Reduction Act, or IRA, that was passed by Congress and signed into law by President Biden more than two years ago, though awareness of some of the provisions is higher among older voters – the group most impacted by the provisions.

- While awareness of Medicare drug negotiations continues to lag, KFF finds widespread support for this policy. Majorities of voters support authorizing the federal government to negotiate drug prices, while one in seven (14%) oppose. This provision is supported by nine in ten Democrats and independent voters (92% and 89%, respectively) and three-quarters of Republican voters (77%). It is also supported by 88% of older adults, those ages 65 and over, including majorities across partisans.

- Voters' views of who is responsible for the legislation as well as the expected savings from the negotiations are largely partisan. Overall, a slight majority (55%) of voters ages 65 and older think Medicare negotiating will lower their own prescription drug costs, but the share who expect to see savings increases to nearly two-thirds (64%) of older Democratic and Democratic-leaning voters. On the other hand, about half (52%) of older Republican and Republican-leaning voters say they don't expect the negotiations to have *any* impact on their drug costs. In addition, voters are also more likely to give their own party leaders credit for passing legislation aimed at lowering the price of prescription drugs for people on Medicare, though Republican voters are less enthusiastic about their party leaders' roles. Larger shares of Democratic voters than Republican voters say President Biden, Vice President Harris, and the Democrats in Congress played a "major" or "minor" role in passing legislation for lowering drug prices for people on Medicare,

while Republican voters are more likely than Democratic voters to say the same about Republicans in Congress. A similar share of Republican voters give former President Trump credit for passing the legislation as give credit to President Biden.

- Vice President Harris' campaign has announced proposals for expanding some of the IRA provisions beyond those with Medicare coverage. Majorities of voters, overall and across partisanship, support these proposed provisions, though smaller shares of Republicans are on board. Three-quarters (77%) of voters support the proposal to expand the $35 cap on out-of-pocket costs for insulin beyond those with Medicare, including majorities of Democratic voters (84%), independent voters (79%), and Republican voters (70%). Seven in ten (69%) voters support the proposal to expand the $2,000 annual limit on out-of-pocket prescription drug costs beyond those with Medicare, including 83% of Democrats, 70% of independents, and 58% of Republicans.

Most Voters Continue to Be Unaware of IRA Provisions to Reduce Prescription Drug Prices

Most voters continue to be unaware of the Medicare drug pricing provisions in the Inflation Reduction Act, or IRA, that was passed by Congress and signed into law by President Biden more than two years ago, though awareness of some of the provisions is higher among older voters – the group most impacted by the provisions.

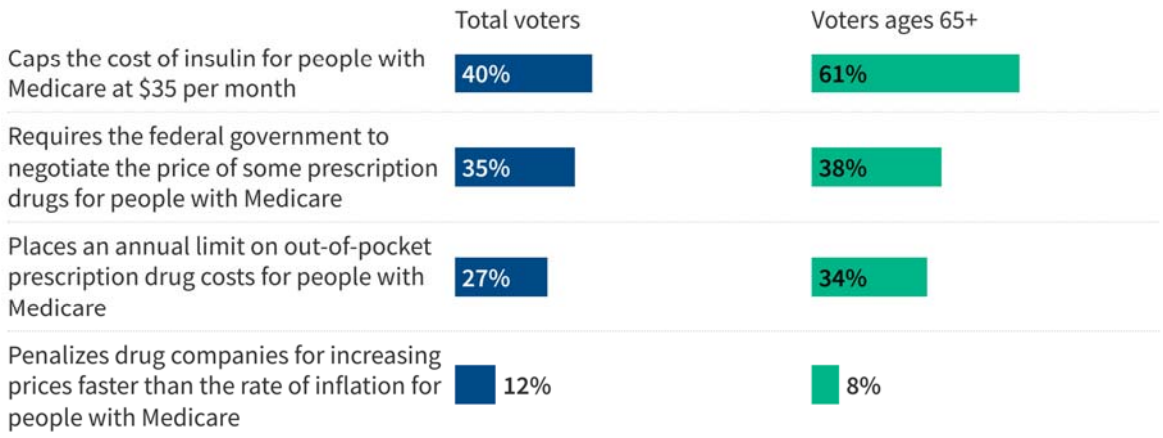
Four in ten voters are now aware there is a federal law in place that caps the cost of insulin for people with Medicare at $35 per month, while another third (35%) are aware of the law that requires the federal government to negotiate the price of some prescription drugs for people with Medicare. A quarter of voters (27%) are aware of the federal law that places a limit on out-of-pocket prescription drug costs for people with Medicare, and one in eight (12%) are aware that there is a law in place that penalizes drug companies for increasing prices faster than the rate of inflation for people with Medicare.

Larger shares of voters ages 65 and older are aware of some of these drug pricing provisions of the IRA. For example, six in ten (61%) voters ages 65 and older are aware of the law that caps the cost of insulin for people with Medicare and about a third (34%) of older voters are aware of the provision that places an out-of-pocket limit on prescription drug costs. Similar shares of older voters compared to younger voters are aware of the provision that requires the government to negotiate the price of some prescription drugs and that penalizes drug companies for increasing prices faster than the rate of inflation for people with Medicare.

Figure 1

Voters Ages 65 and Older Are More Likely to Know That Federal Law Caps the Cost of Insulin for People With Medicare

Percent who say, as far as they know, there is a federal law in place that does each of the following:



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

While awareness of the Medicare drug pricing provisions increased, especially among older voters, from November 2023 to May 2024, awareness has remained steady over the past several months.

Voters Remain Unaware of Impact of Medicare Drug Negotiations, Older Adults Are Unclear if It Will Reduce Their Prescription Costs

The Biden administration recently announced that the lower prices negotiated for some prescription drugs would have saved the federal government $6 billion in 2023 with an estimated $1.5 billion reduction in out-of-pocket costs for older adults when lower prices take effect in 2026. Large majorities of voters have not heard about these projected savings, with almost half (45%) who say they have heard “nothing at all” about the negotiations, while a quarter (25%) have heard “a lot” or “some.” Another three in ten (30%) have heard “a little” about the negotiations.

Larger shares of older voters, those ages 65 and over, say they’ve heard “a lot” or “some” about these savings, with a third (32%) who say so, compared to one in five (22%) of those under age 65.

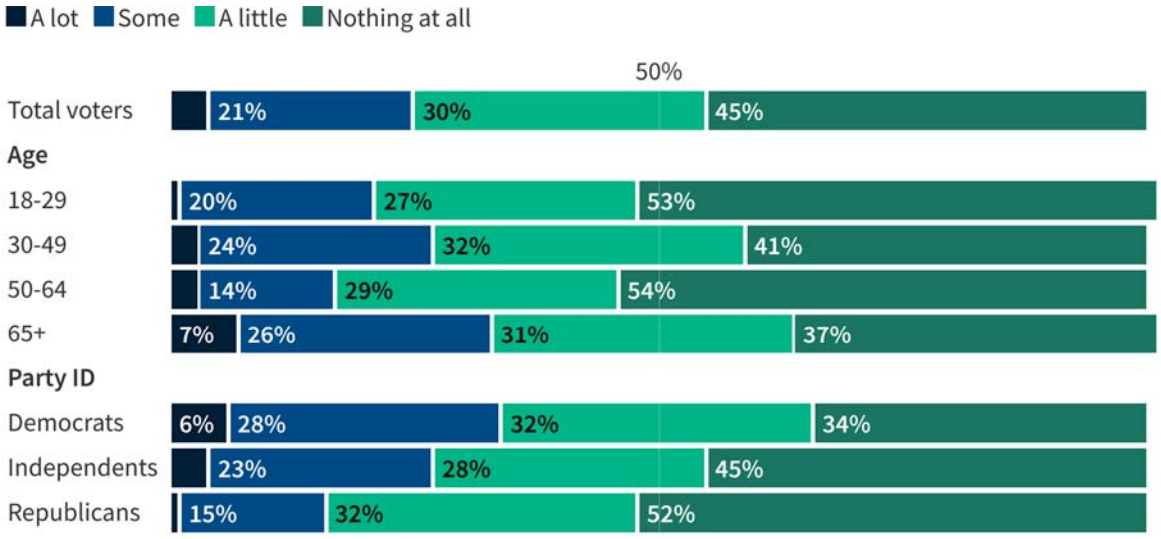
Similarly, larger shares of Democratic and independent voters have heard about the projected savings, with about a third (34%) of Democrats and a quarter (27%) of independents who have heard at least “some,” compared to about one in six (16%) Republican voters.

Figure 2

Very Few Voters Have Heard of Savings From Drug Price Negotiations, With Larger Shares of Democrats, Older Adults Who Have

The Biden administration recently announced that in 2026, the federal government will save $6 billion from negotiating the price of some prescription drugs for people with Medicare and out-of-pocket savings for older adults could total up to $1.5 billion.

How much have you heard, if anything, about these estimated savings?



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

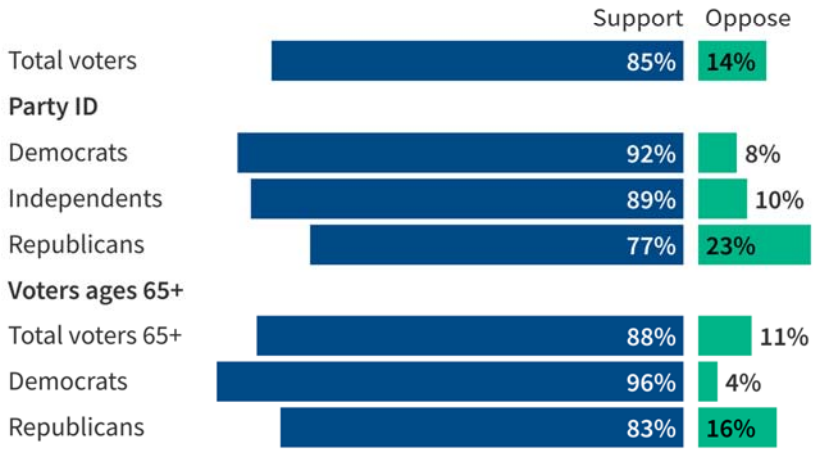
KFF

Overall, almost nine in ten (85%) voters support authorizing the federal government to negotiate drug prices, while one in seven (14%) oppose. This provision is supported by 92% of Democratic voters, 89% of independent voters, and 77% of Republican voters. While support for the law is lower among Republicans, most Republican voters support it.

Figure 3

Majorities Across Partisanship Support Portion of the Inflation Reduction Act That Authorizes the Federal Government to Negotiate the Price of Prescription Medication

Do you support or oppose authorizing the federal government to negotiate the price of some prescription drugs for people with Medicare?



Note: Among registered voters. Voters ages 65 and older by party ID includes independents who lean toward either party. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

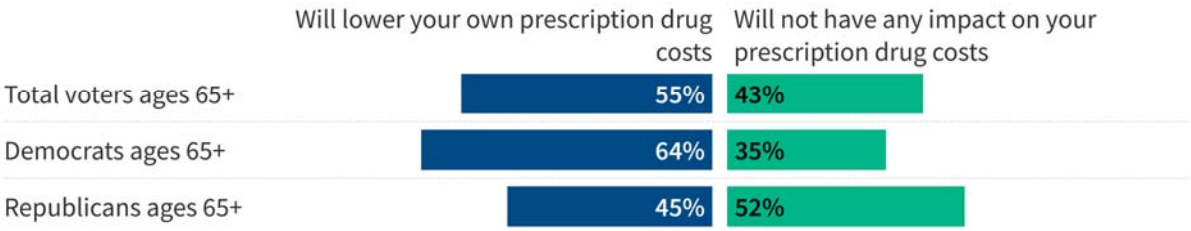
KFF

In addition to supporting the federal government negotiations, a slight majority (55%) of voters ages 65 and older think Medicare negotiations will lower their own prescription drug costs, while four in ten (43%) older voters think negotiating won't have *any* impact on their prescription drug costs. Expectations that Medicare negotiations won't lower drug costs seem to be partisan, with two-thirds (64%) of older Democratic and Democratic-leaning voters thinking it will lower their drug costs, while about half (52%) of older Republican and Republican-leaning voters thinking it won't have any impact on their drug costs.

Figure 4

Over Half of Older Voters Say Authorizing the Government to Negotiate With Pharmaceutical Companies Will Lower Their Prescription Drug Costs

Do you think authorizing the government to negotiate with pharmaceutical companies...



Note: Among registered voters ages 65+. Partisans include those who lean toward either party. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

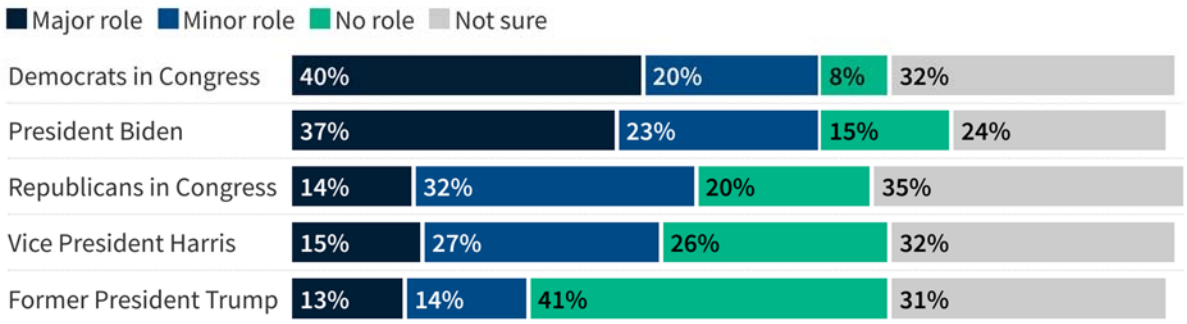
The Inflation Reduction Act was enacted under President Biden without any Republican support in Congress. Six in ten voters say President Biden had a “major” or “minor” role in passing the recent law aimed at lowering drug prices for people on Medicare, including four in ten (37%) who say he had a “major” role. Similar shares of voters say the same about Democrats in Congress, with six in ten (60%) who say they played a “major” or “minor” role. Another four in ten (42%) voters say Vice President Harris played a role. Credit for the recent law could be key as she picks up these issues on her own platform for president.

Almost half (46%) of voters think that Republicans in Congress played a role in passing the recent law, with a small share saying they played a “major” role (14%). About a quarter of voters credit former President Trump for the passage of the law aimed at lowering drug prices for those on Medicare, with a quarter (28%) who say he played a “major” or “minor” role, while 41% say he had no role in passing the recent law. Between a quarter and a third of voters aren’t sure how big of a role these groups played in the health care legislation.

Figure 5

Large Shares of Voters See Biden, Democrats in Congress as Having a Role in Passing Law Aimed at Lowering Drug Prices for People on Medicare

Do you think each of these had a major role, a minor role, or no role in passing recent laws aimed at lower drug prices for people on Medicare, or are you not sure?



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

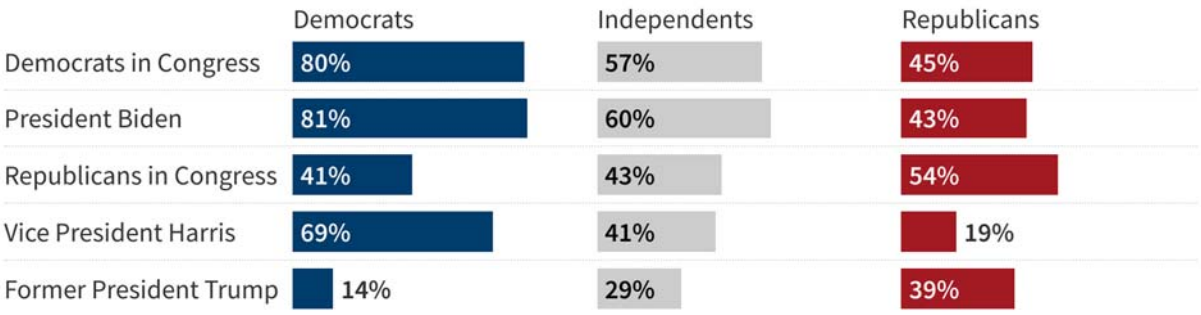
Partisans are more likely to give their own party leaders credit for passing legislation aimed at lowering the price of prescription drugs for people on Medicare, though Republican voters are less enthusiastic about their party leaders' roles. Larger shares of Democratic voters than Republican voters say President Biden, Vice President Harris, and the Democrats in Congress played a "major" or "minor" role in passing legislation for lowering drug prices for people on Medicare. While Republican voters are more likely than Democratic voters to say former President Trump and the Republicans in Congress played a role, only about a quarter of Republican voters said either (23% and 24%, respectively) played a "major role." In fact, a similar share of Republican voters give former President Trump credit for passing the legislation as give credit to President Biden.

Overall, eight in ten (81%) Democratic voters say Biden played a role in passing the legislation, four in ten (39%) of Republican voters say the same about Trump. Another eight in ten Democratic voters say Democrats in Congress played a "major" or "minor" role in passing the legislation, while over half (54%) of Republicans say the same about Republicans in Congress.

Figure 6

Democratic Voters Are More Likely to Say Democrats Had a Role in Passing Drug Pricing Law Than Republican Voters Are About Republicans in Congress

Percent who say each of the following had a **major** or **minor role** in passing recent laws aimed at lower drug prices for people on Medicare:



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.
Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF

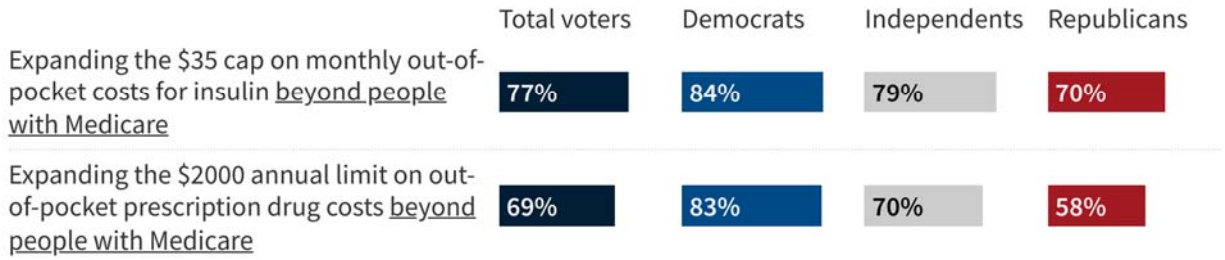
Voters Support Expanding on IRA Provisions

Vice President Harris' campaign has announced that, if elected, her administration hopes to expand some of the drug pricing legislation beyond just those with Medicare, allowing others to benefit from the cap on monthly out-of-pocket costs for those with insulin and the annual limit on out-of-pocket prescription drug costs. Former President Trump has remained silent on some of these issues, though his administration implemented a program under which Medicare plans voluntarily lowered insulin copays to $35 per month. Majorities of voters, overall and across partisanship, support these proposed provisions, though smaller shares of Republicans are on board. Three-quarters (77%) of voters support the proposal to expand the $35 cap on out-of-pocket costs for insulin beyond those with Medicare, including majorities of Democratic voters (84%), independent voters (79%), and Republican voters (70%). Seven in ten (69%) voters support the proposal to expand the $2,000 annual limit on out-of-pocket prescription drug costs beyond those with Medicare, including 83% of Democrats, 70% of independents, and 58% of Republicans.

Figure 7

Majorities of Voters Across Partisanship Support Proposals to Expand IRA Provisions Beyond Those With Medicare

Percent who say they **support** each of the following:



Note: Among registered voters. See topline for full question wording.

Source: KFF Health Tracking Poll (Aug. 26-Sept. 4, 2024)

KFF